Ashyanna Alexine Barodi Bangcola

Ashyanna Alexine Adia Amira-Labi Barodi Ali Pinto Bangcola is a Filipino diplomat, lawyer, and Shari'ah counselor from the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM).

She currently serves as a Foreign Service Officer, Class IV, at the Department of Foreign Affairs (DFA), where she works as Principal Assistant at the Maritime and Ocean Affairs Office.

Bangcola is known for her work in law, diplomacy, Shari'ah practice, and human rights advocacy, and for her efforts to promote greater understanding of the Bangsamoro people and Muslim Filipinos at large.

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Early Life and Education

Bangcola comes from a family that placed a strong premium on education, leadership, and public service, values that shaped her path early on.

She graduated as Valedictorian of La Salle Academy, a distinction that set the tone for the academic path she would go on to build.

Throughout her student years, she found her footing in public speaking and competitive debate, a pursuit she carried from high school all the way through law school.

That training paid off in a big way during the ANC Law School Debate Competition, where she led Arellano University to a championship win, snapping a 16-year title drought for the school.

In that same competition, she became the first Muslim Maranaw to be named both Champion and Best Speaker, a milestone that spoke not just to her own sharpness as a debater but to the wider presence of Muslim Filipinos in national academic competitions.

Ashyanna Alexine Barodi Bangcola



Full Name

Ashyanna Alexine Adia Amira-Labi Barodi Ali Pinto Bangcola

Born

Philippines (Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao)

Ethnicity

Maranaw

Occupation

Diplomat, lawyer, Shari'ah counselor, educator

Years Active

2020Template:Ndashpresent

Education

La Salle Academy (secondary)
De La SalleTemplate:NdashCollege of Saint Benilde (Consular and Diplomatic Affairs)
Arellano University School of Law

Notable Positions

Foreign Service Officer, Class IV, Department of Foreign Affairs
Principal Assistant, Maritime and Ocean Affairs Office

Notability

Her interest in international affairs led her to the Consular and Diplomatic Affairs program at De La Salle-College of Saint Benilde, where she graduated Cum Laude and received a Leadership Award recognizing both her academic standing and her service to the student community.

While at Benilde, she represented the school as a delegate to Model United Nations (MUN) conferences held in New York and Rome, an early taste of the diplomatic world she would later enter professionally.

She then pursued law at Arellano University School of Law, where she graduated as the school's 8th Honorable Mention.

One of the youngest Filipino diplomats of her generation and the first Muslim Maranaw to be named Champion and Best Speaker at the ANC Law School Debate Competition.

Known For

Bridging legal practice, Shari'ah counseling, and diplomatic service while championing Bangsamoro identity and Muslim Filipino representation.

In 2020, at just 23 years old, she passed the Philippine Bar Examinations.

Two years after that, she added another credential to her name by passing the Shari'ah Bar Examinations, becoming a licensed Shari'ah lawyer at 24.

Early Career

Even before joining the diplomatic service, Bangcola had already built a solid record in government and public affairs work.

She served at the Commission on Filipinos Overseas, worked as a legal researcher for the Bangsamoro Transition Authority under the Office of Parliament Member Atty. Maisara C. Dandamun-Latiph at the Institute for Peace and Development in Marawi City, and taught law at Mindanao State University.

These roles gave her a close-up view of governance, migration, peacebuilding, and the legal issues facing Muslim Filipinos and the wider Filipino public.

She is also an active member of Kalilintad sa Lanao, a community-based volunteer group working on peacebuilding in Lanao del Sur through youth empowerment and education initiatives.

Diplomatic Career

Bangcola's biggest career turning point came when she passed the Foreign Service Officer Examination (FSOE), widely regarded as one of the toughest government exams in the Philippines.

She was one of only 18 successful examinees in her batch, and she joined the DFA as a Foreign Service Officer at 25, placing her among the youngest Filipino diplomats of her generation.

In 2023, she took her oath as Foreign Service Officer, Class IV, and was assigned to the Maritime and Ocean Affairs Office of the DFA.

In this post, she works on protecting and advancing Philippine interests in maritime and ocean governance, including the country's sovereign rights and jurisdiction in the West Philippine Sea.<ref>Template:Cite news</ref>

She has taken part in important international engagements as well, including ASEAN-related discussions on regional maritime issues.

Bangcola has also spoken at youth and professional gatherings about her path into the foreign service, encouraging aspiring diplomats and lawyers to read widely and stay anchored to their sense of purpose.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref>

Further Studies

Bangcola's drive for excellence carried over into international legal education.

In 2025, she attended the 12th Yeosu Academy of the Law of the Sea in Yeosu, South Korea, an intensive international diploma program with participants from multiple countries.

She graduated from the program Summa Cum Laude, earning the academy's highest distinction for her performance in the law of the sea.

Advocacy

Beyond her professional work, Bangcola has used her platform to advocate for the Bangsamoro people and Muslim Filipinos more broadly.

She speaks often about preserving cultural heritage, strengthening peace efforts, and encouraging young Muslims to pursue excellence in education and public service.

She is also a cofounder of Global Marawi, a digital initiative aimed at putting the city of Marawi on the international map and pushing back against the prejudice its residents have faced.<ref>Template:Cite news</ref>

Her career reflects a belief that professional achievement and cultural identity are not in tension but can move forward together, in service of nation-building.

See also

- Bangsamoro
- Department of Foreign Affairs (Philippines)
- Shari'ah
- Maranao people

References

- Profile provided by **Saliha Barodi Ali** (https://www.facebook.com/salibrdiali)

External links

- LinkedIn profile (https://www.linkedin.com/in/ashyanna-alexine-ali-bangcola)

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